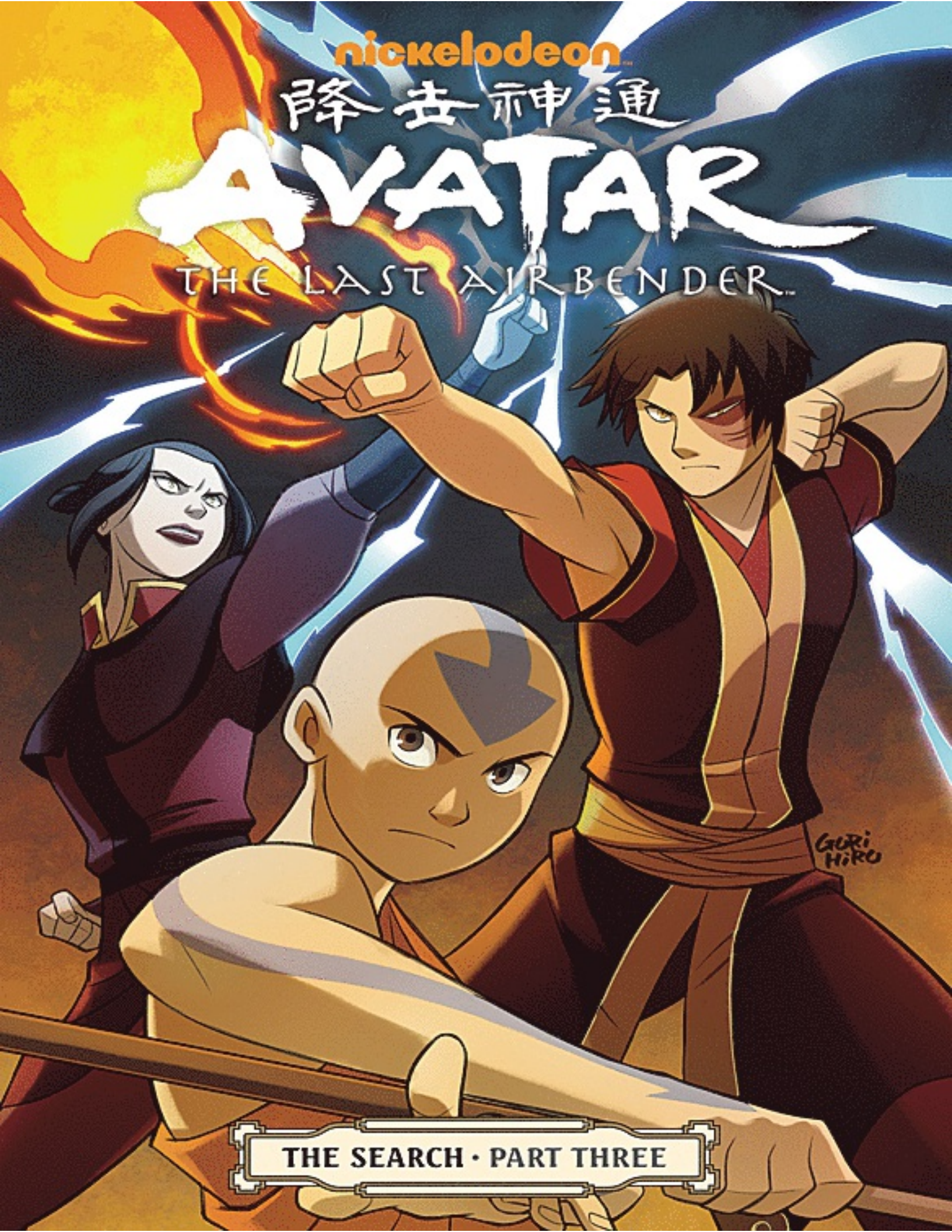


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AVATAR

THE LAST AIRBENDER



THE SEARCH • PART THREE

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Created by

Bryan Konietzko

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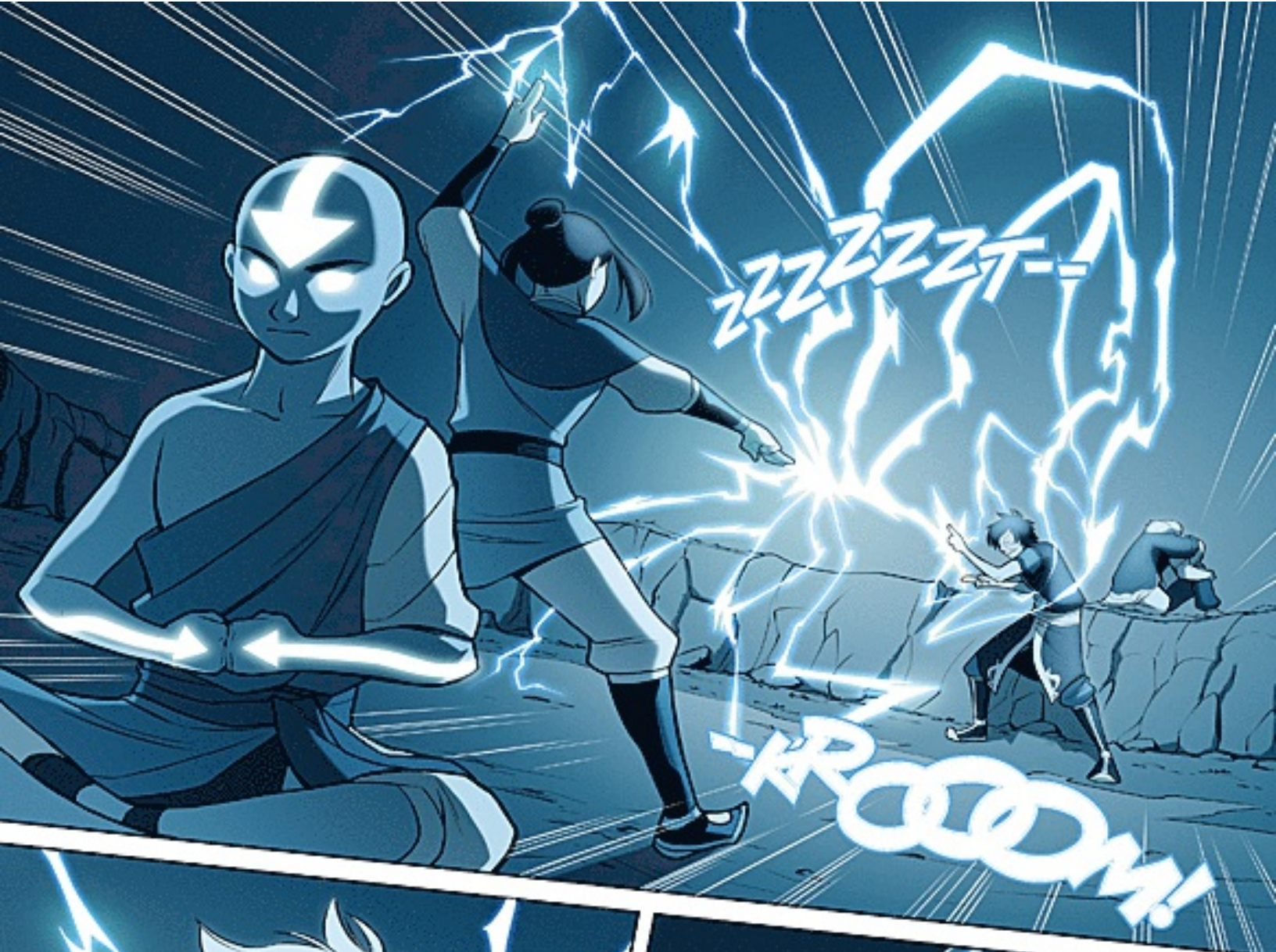
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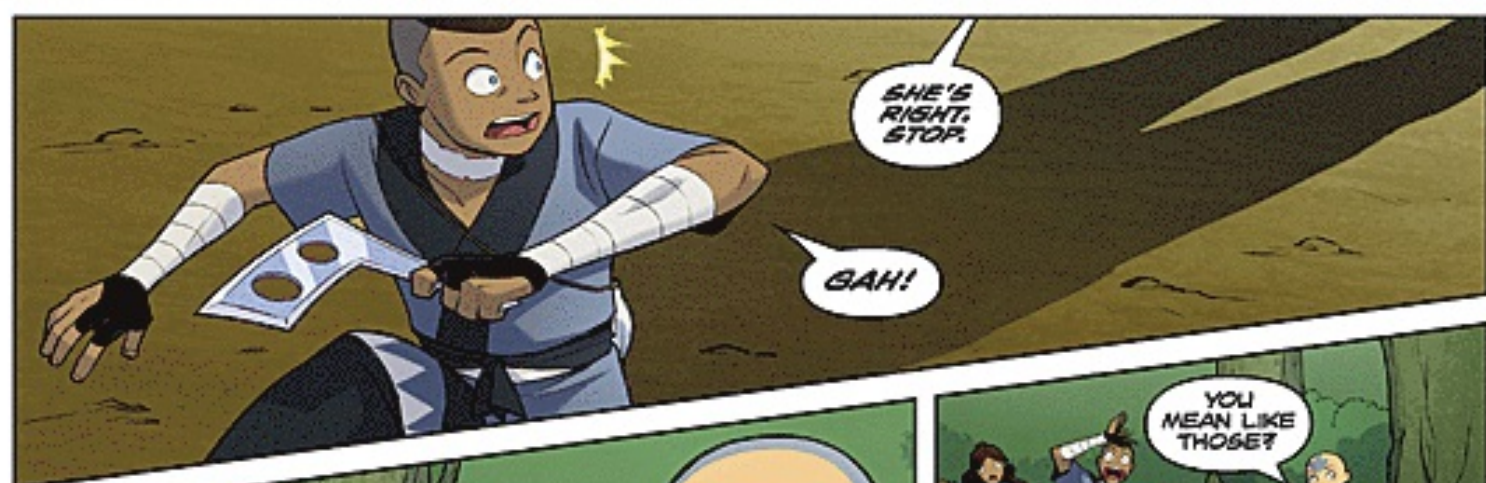
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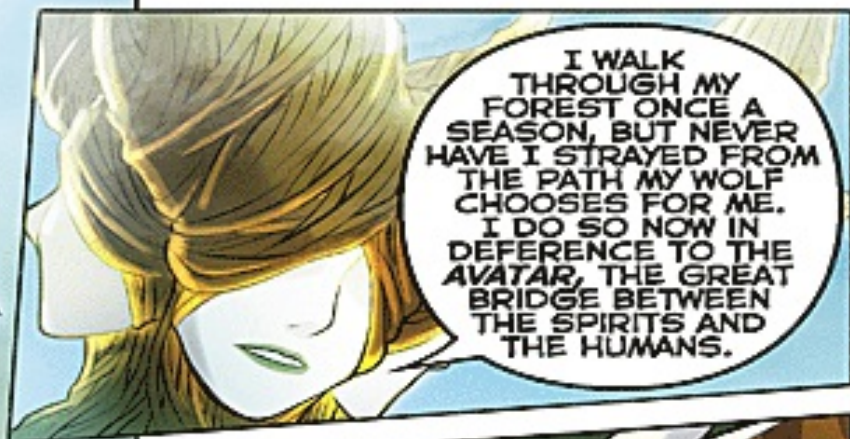






I AM THE
MOTHER OF FACES.
THROUGH ME,
SEPARATENESS CAME
INTO THE WORLD.
THROUGH ME, CAME
IDENTITY.

THE
ONE BECAME
THE MANY.

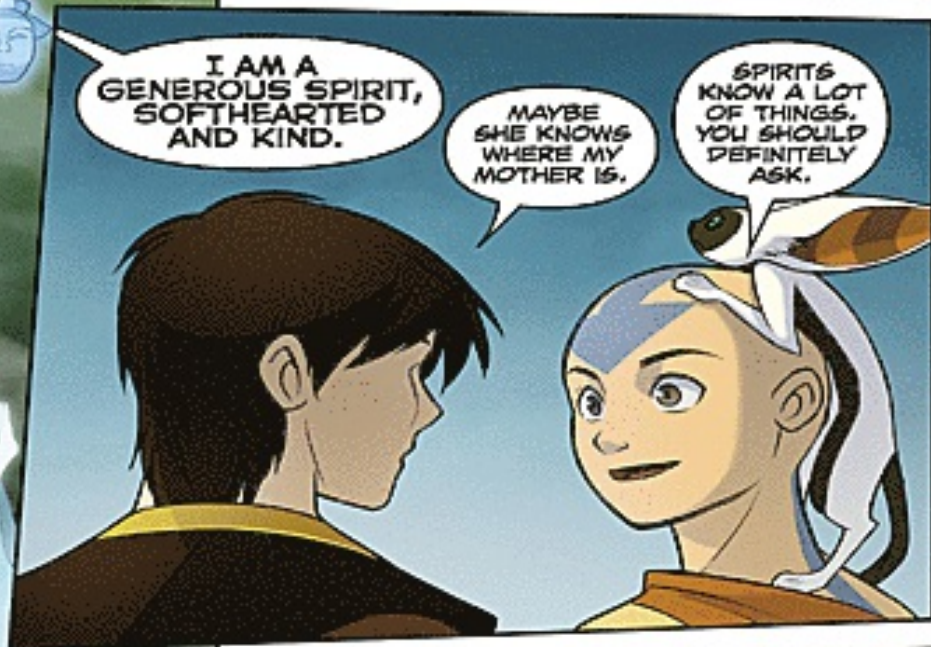


I WALK
THROUGH MY
FOREST ONCE A
SEASON, BUT NEVER
HAVE I STRAYED FROM
THE PATH MY WOLF
CHOSES FOR ME.
I DO SO NOW IN
DEFERENCE TO THE
AVATAR, THE GREAT
BRIDGE BETWEEN
THE SPIRITS AND
THE HUMANS.



SEET
WHAT'D I
TELL YAT?

ALL
RIGHT, ALL
RIGHT, SO YOU'RE
GREAT BRIDGE
GUY! NOBODY
EVER SAID YOU
WEREN'T!



I AM A
GENEROUS SPIRIT,
SOFTHEARTED
AND KIND.

MAYBE
SHE KNOWS
WHERE MY
MOTHER IS.

SPIRITS
KNOW A LOT
OF THINGS.
YOU SHOULD
DEFINITELY
ASK.



EACH
SEASON, I
GRANT ONE
FAVOR TO ONE
HUMAN. YOU MAY
MAKE YOUR
REQUEST
NOW.



WAIT.
JUST
ONE?

ONE.



HUMANS
LIKE YOU OFTEN
CHASE AFTER ME,
BEGGING FOR NEW
IDENTITIES. HAVE
YOU COME TO DO
THE SAME?



SEE, HERE'S
THE THING -- WE
ACTUALLY NEED **TWO**
FAVORS. I'M SURE A
BIG-AND-GIGANTIC-YET-
BEAUTIFUL-AND-LOVELY
SPIRIT LIKE YOU CAN
HANDLE **TWO**
FAVORS, RIGHT?

YOUR, UH...
FACE-INESS?



DO NOT
TEST MY
GENEROSITY,
YOUNG
AVATAR.

ONE.



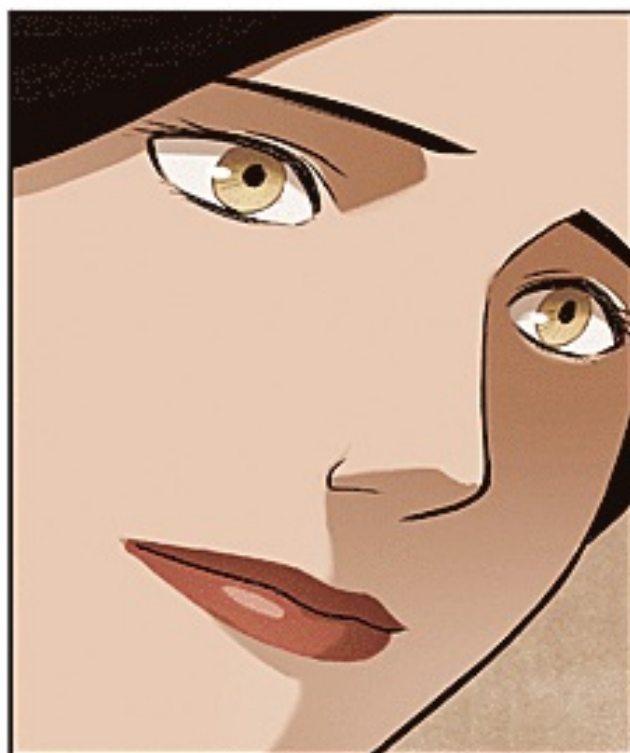














BUT IF I GOT A NEW FACE...A NEW IDENTITY...MAYBE I COULD RETURN TO THE CAPITAL CITY UNDETECTED!

MAYBE I COULD AT LEAST SEE MY CHILDREN AGAIN...MAKE SURE THEY'RE OKAY!



BUT WHAT THEN? WOULD YOU STAY IN THE CITY, HOPING TO CATCH A GLIMPSE OF THEM FROM TIME TO TIME? WATCH THEM GROW UP FROM AFAR? WHAT KIND OF LIFE IS THAT?



YOU DON'T KNOW WHAT IT'S LIKE.

THEY'RE ALWAYS HERE. A PART OF ME WONDERS WHAT THEY'RE DOING... WONDERS IF THEY'RE HAPPY OR SAD OR IN PAIN... ALWAYS.

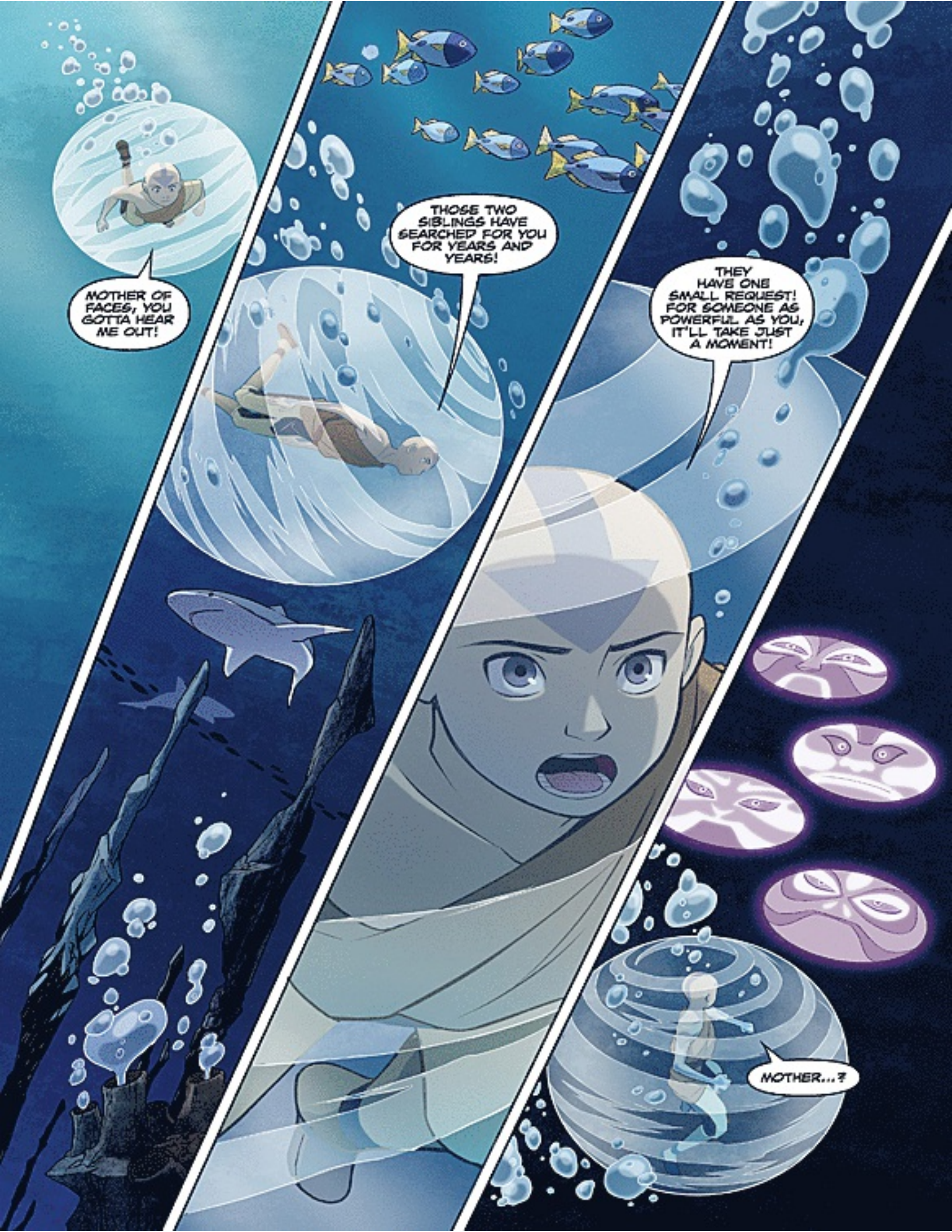
IT'S TORTURE.



COME ON. LET'S GO DOWN TO FORGETFUL VALLEY, IKEM.

LET'S GO MEET THIS SPIRIT OF YOURS.





MOTHER OF
FACES, YOU
GOTTA HEAR
ME OUT!

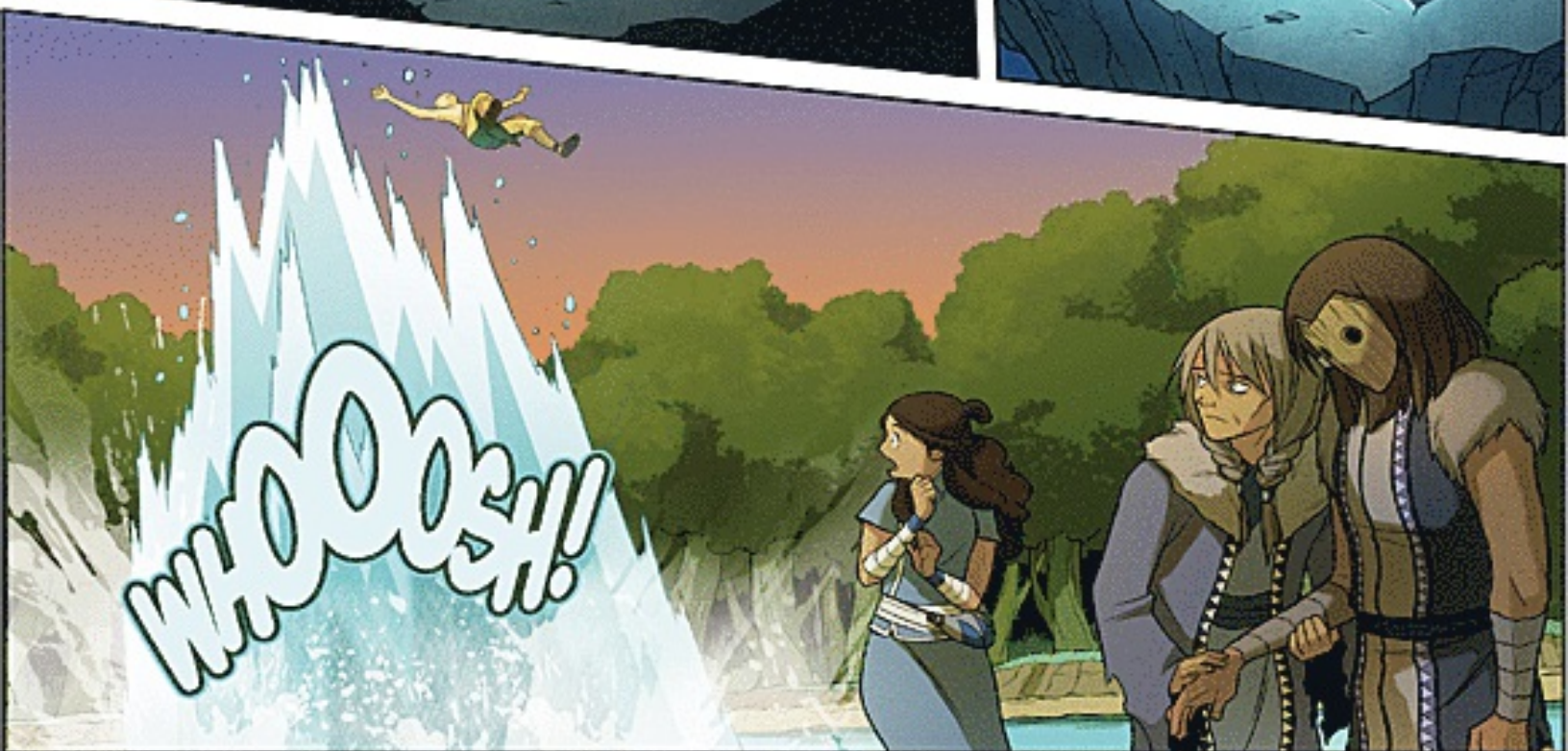
THOSE TWO
SIBLINGS HAVE
SEARCHED FOR YOU
FOR YEARS AND
YEARS!

THEY
HAVE ONE
SMALL REQUEST!
FOR SOMEONE AS
POWERFUL AS YOU,
IT'LL TAKE JUST
A MOMENT!

MOTHER...?













GET OUT!

GET OUT!

GET OUT!

GET OUT!

GET OUT!

GET OUT!

GET OUT!

GET OUT!

GET OUT!

GET OUT!

GET OUT!

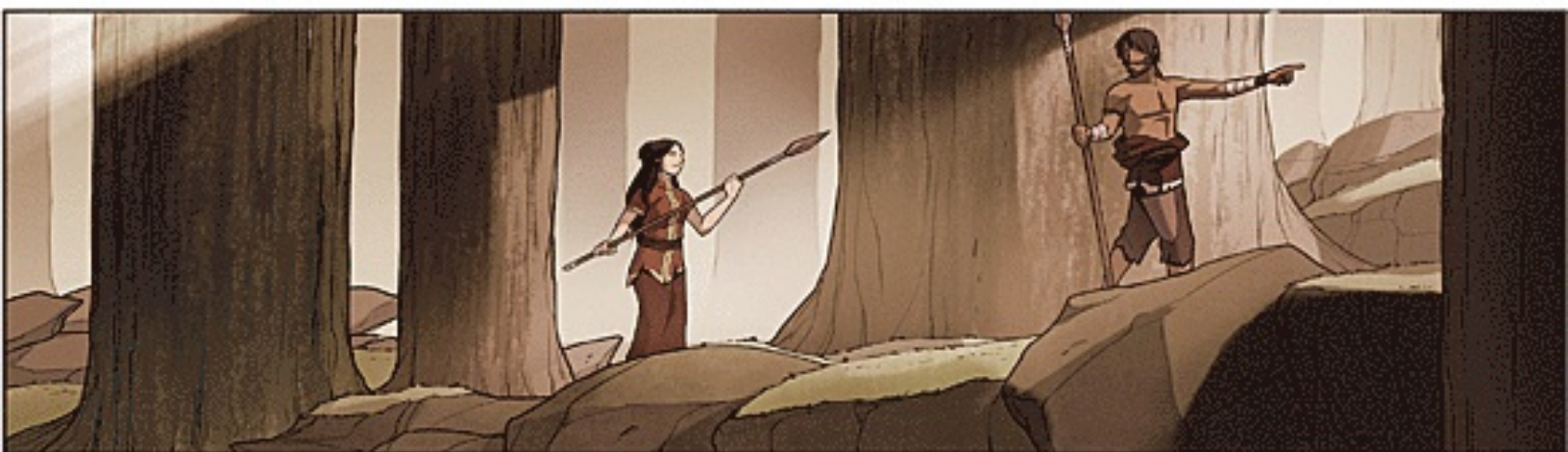
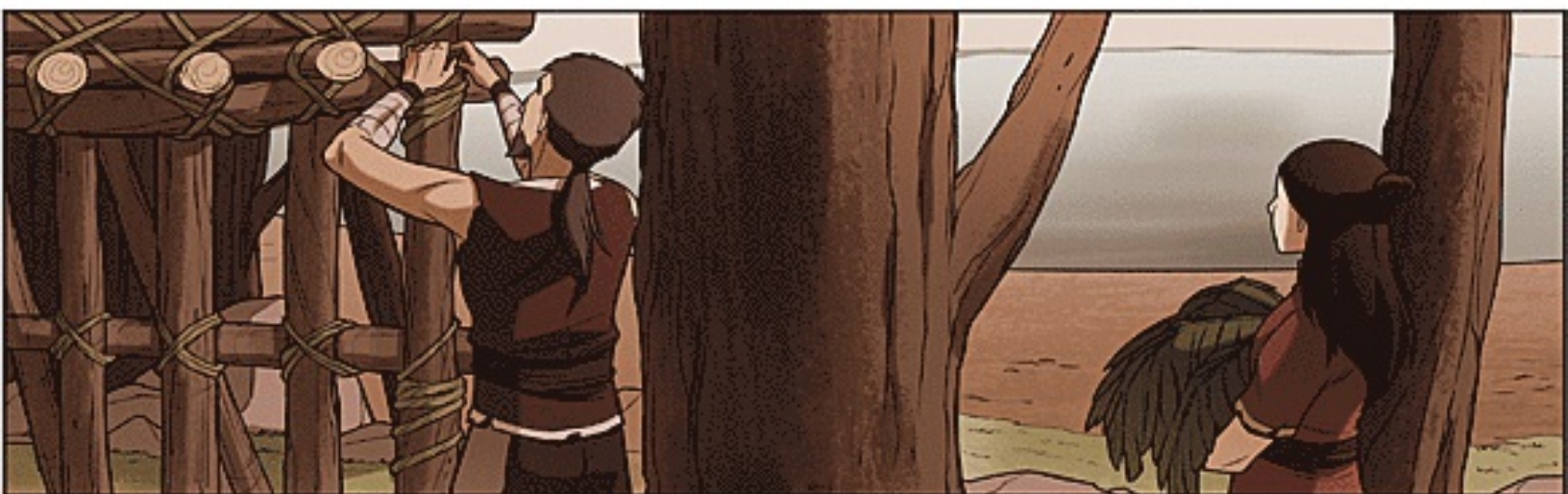
GET OUT!

GET OUT!

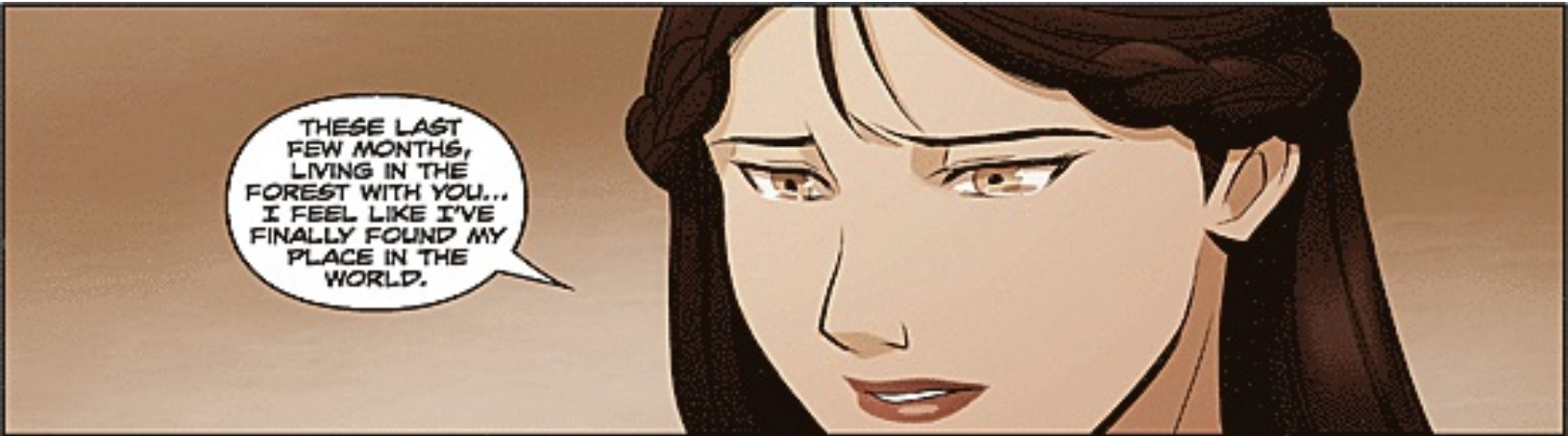
GET OUT!

GET OUT!









THESE LAST
FEW MONTHS,
LIVING IN THE
FOREST WITH YOU...
I FEEL LIKE I'VE
FINALLY FOUND MY
PLACE IN THE
WORLD.



MAYBE THERE'S
ANOTHER OPTION! WHAT IF
YOU BRING YOUR KIDS BACK
TO HIRA'A? WE COULD ALL
LIVE TOGETHER, LIKE A
FAMILY!



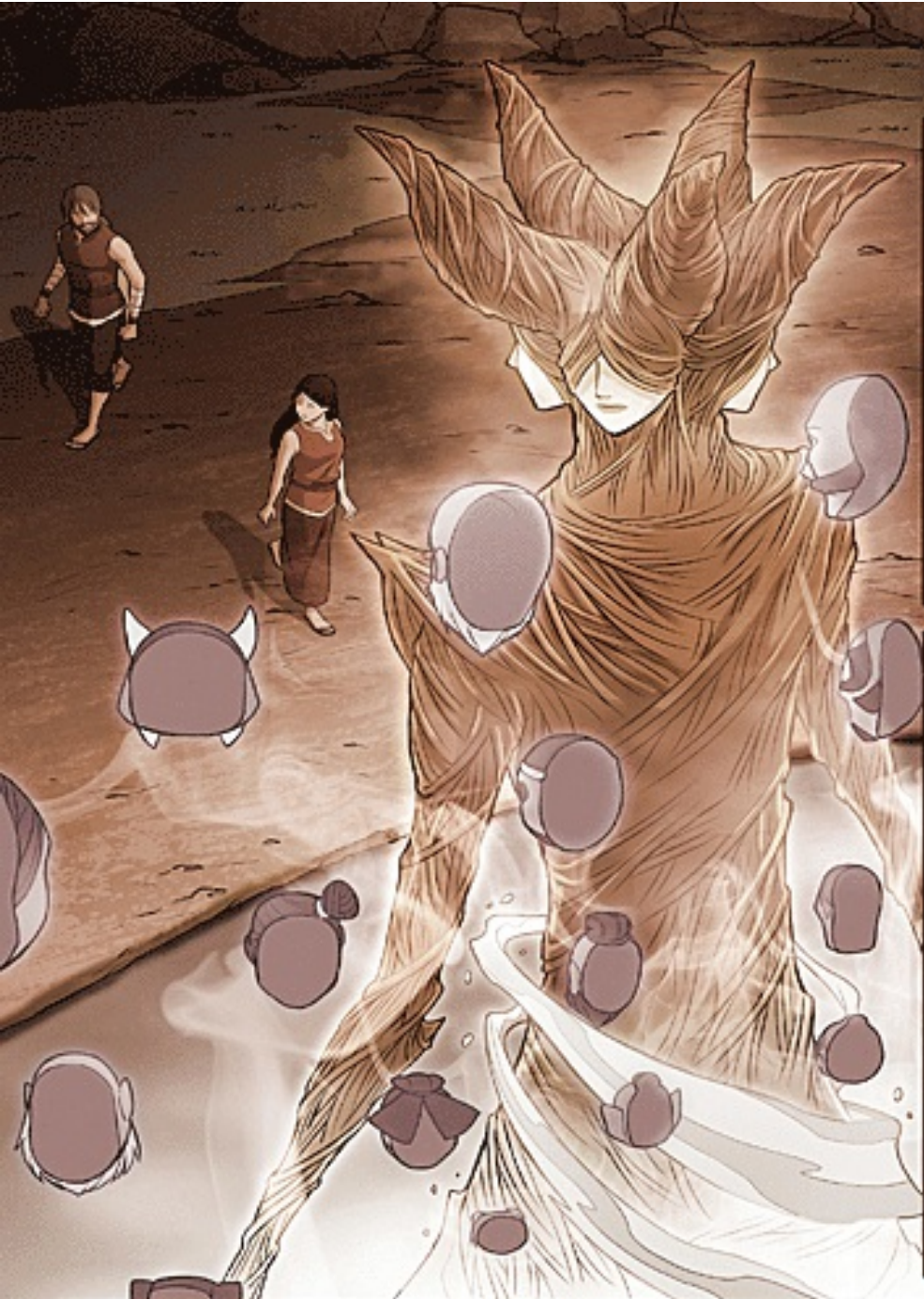
YOU
DON'T KNOW
WHAT *OZA'* IS LIKE.
I WOULDN'T JUST BE
ENDANGERING ME AND
MY CHILDREN, I'D
BE ENDANGERING
YOU.

AND
PROBABLY
THE WHOLE
TOWN.



LET'S
GO.

BLUB BLUB BLUB



HUMAN,
WHAT DO
YOU ASK
OF ME?



MOTHER
OF FACES,
PARDON THIS
INTRUSION.

MY NAME IS
URSA. I--I
HEARD YOU CAN
GIVE ME A NEW
FACE. A NEW
IDENTITY.



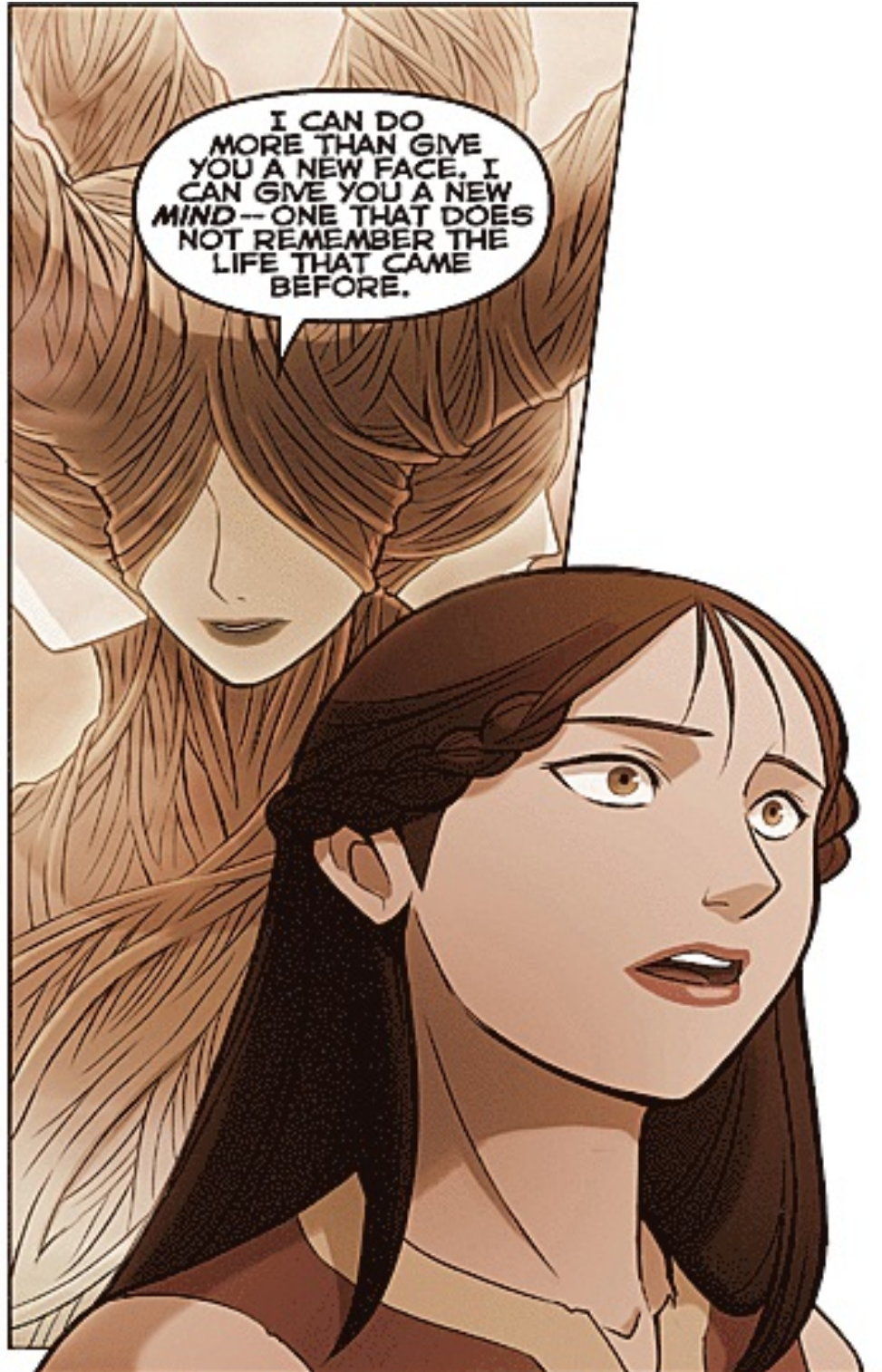
WHY
WOULD
A WOMAN OF
SUCH BEAUTY
DESIRE A NEW
FACE? WOULD YOU
BE WILLING TO
ACCEPT ONE
MUCH PLAINER
THAN YOUR
OWN?

ANY FACE
WILL DO, AS
LONG AS IT'S
NEW.



URSA, I
SENSE MUCH
PAIN IN YOU.
DO YOU REALLY
BELIEVE A NEW
FACE WILL
RELIEVE YOU
OF THIS
PAIN?

NO. OF
COURSE NOT. MY
PAIN COMES FROM
THE MEMORIES OF
A LIFE THAT I DID
NOT CHOOSE FOR
MYSELF.



I CAN DO
MORE THAN GIVE
YOU A NEW FACE. I
CAN GIVE YOU A NEW
MIND—ONE THAT DOES
NOT REMEMBER THE
LIFE THAT CAME
BEFORE.



WILL I
REMEMBER
HIM?

IS HE A
PART OF THE
LIFE YOU WISH
TO FORGET?

NO.

THEN
YOU WILL
REMEMBER
HIM.



HOW ABOUT MY CHILDREN? WILL I REMEMBER MY CHILDREN?

ARE THEY A PART OF THE LIFE YOU WISH TO FORGET?

YES.

THEN YOU WILL NOT REMEMBER THEM.

YOU MUST DECIDE.

ZINO... AZILA... I'M SO HORRIBLE...



DO
YOU WISH
TO HAVE BOTH
A NEW FACE
AND A NEW
MIND?

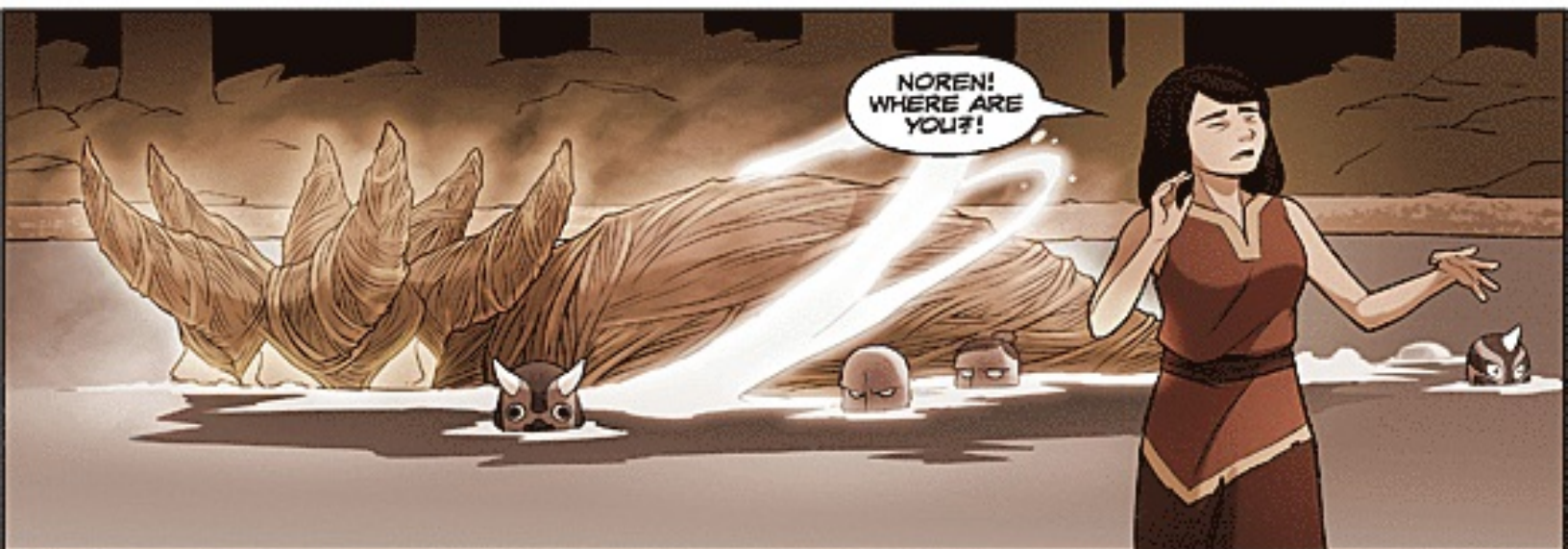


YES.



HOLD
STILL.

























REPEAT
WHAT YOU
SAID,
AVATAR.

KOH THE
FACE STEALER.
HE'S A SPIRIT WHO
LOOKS KINDA LIKE
A BIG UGLY SOW
BUG WITH THESE BIG
UGLY LEGS AND A
BUNCH OF BIG UGLY
FACES. HE'S --



HE
IS MY
SON.



THAT IS
NOT THE
NAME I GAVE
HIM, BUT
YES.

KOH THE
FACE STEALER IS
YOUR SON?



OH,
HEH HEH.
DID I SAY
"UGLY"? I
MEANT,
UH --

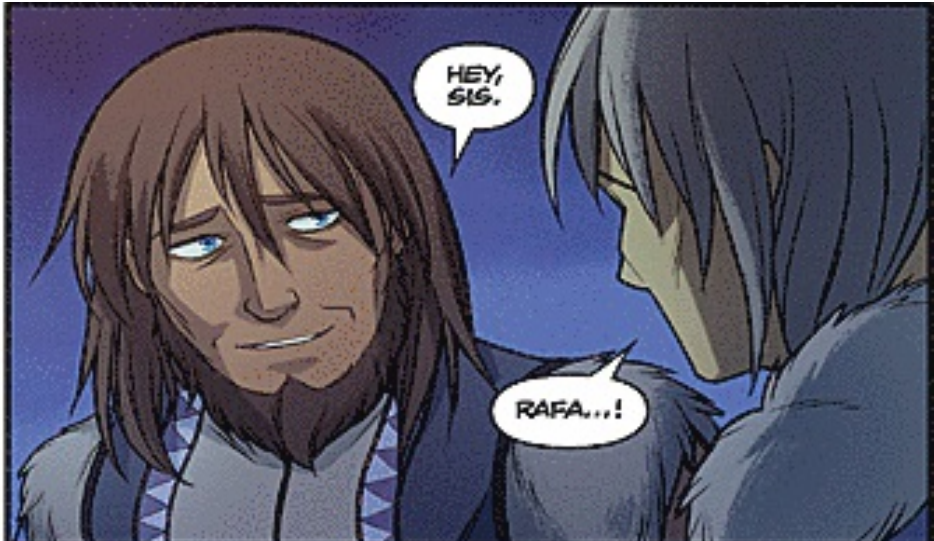
HE'S BEEN
ESTRANGED FROM
ME SINCE TIME BEGAN.
THE LEGENDS SAY THAT
HE MISSES ME SO MUCH,
HE'S SPENT ALL OF
HISTORY STEALING
FACES. HOW DO
YOU KNOW HIM,
AVATAR?



WE'VE MET.
AND TO TELL YOU
THE TRUTH, MOTHER OF
FACES, YOUR SON ISN'T
THE NICEST OF SPIRITS.
HE TOOK SOMEONE
IMPORTANT AWAY FROM
ONE OF MY PAST
LIVES.

AND
YET MY PAST
LIFE SPARED
HIM.





-- AND ANOTHER
BETWEEN A
MOTHER AND
A SON.



WHEN I SAW
YOU IN THE CROWD,
I RECOGNIZED YOU
IMMEDIATELY BECAUSE OF
YOUR SCAR. I HAD LEARNED
ALL I COULD ABOUT URSA'S
LIFE IN THE ROYAL PALACE.
I KNEW IT WOULD COME
BACK TO HAUNT US
SOMEDAY.



FORGIVE ME FOR NOT
CONFESSING THE WHOLE TRUTH
WHEN YOU AND YOUR FRIENDS
WERE HERE, FIRE LORD. I HAD
HOPED TO GIVE YOU ENOUGH
INFORMATION TO SATISFY YOU,
YET STILL PROTECT MY HOME
HERE WITH URSA.

"URSA"...?



THAT WAS YOUR
OLD NAME, MY LOVE,
FROM YOUR OLD
LIFE.

YOU
WERE ONCE
A PRINCESS OF
THE FIRE NATION.
YOU HAD TWO
CHILDREN, ONE OF
WHOM GREW UP
TO BE THE FIRE
LORD.

MOMMY?
WHAT'S DADDY
TALKING ABOUT?



YOU DON'T
REMEMBER ANY
OF THIS BECAUSE A
POWERFUL SPIRIT
ALTERED YOUR
MEMORIES.







WHACK! THUMP! THUMP!

FIRE LORD, WHAT'S GOING ON?!

STAY HERE. I'LL GO FIND OUT.

DADDY, I'M SCARED!

THUMP!
THUMP!
THUMP!

SOUNDS LIKE SOMEONE'S FIGHTING ON OUR ROOF!



OH NO.



I SAID
GET OUT OF
MY WAY!

NSH!

ZZZ-KRAKKA
BOOM!



YOU!
FINALLY!

I CAN'T
TELL YOU
HOW LONG
I'VE DREAMED
OF THIS
MOMENT!



MOMMY!



TELL ME,
MOTHER, DID
YOU HAVE TO HAVE
A NEW DAUGHTER
BECAUSE YOUR
LAST ONE TURNED
OUT TO BE SUCH
A MONSTER?!



STAY
BACK,
AZULA!

HA HA! BACK
FOR MORE,
SNOW PEASANT?!
WHERE'S YOUR
LITTLE TOY?



RIGHT
THERE.













NO, YOU'RE
WRONG.

OH,
STOP KIDDING
YOURSELF!

THE OTHER MORNING
WHEN YOU HAD ME OVER
THAT CLIFF, WHY DIDN'T YOU
JUST LET GO? YOU COULD'VE
GOTTEN RID OF ME AND
THIS LETTER!



IT WOULD
HAVE BEEN
SO EASY!

ADMIT IT!
YOU NEED ME
TO HELP YOU
BE FREE!



IN MY
HEART, I KNOW
-- I'VE ALWAYS
KNOWN --



-- THAT THE
THRONE IS MY
DESTINY.



THAT
MORNING ON
THE CLIFF...

AZULA,
OUR RELATIONSHIP
IS SO MESSED UP.
IT'S BEEN LIKE THAT
AS LONG AS I CAN
REMEMBER. AND MAYBE
IT'LL BE LIKE THAT
FOR THE REST OF
OUR LIVES.

BUT
ONE FACT
NEVER CHANGES.
NO MATTER WHAT,
YOU'RE STILL MY
SISTER.











HUMAN, DO
YOU WISH TO
RETURN TO WHO
YOU ONCE
WERE?

DO
YOU WISH TO
REMEMBER?



NO, YOU DON'T
HAVE TO. YOU HAVE
SUCH A BEAUTIFUL
LIFE HERE.

YES.

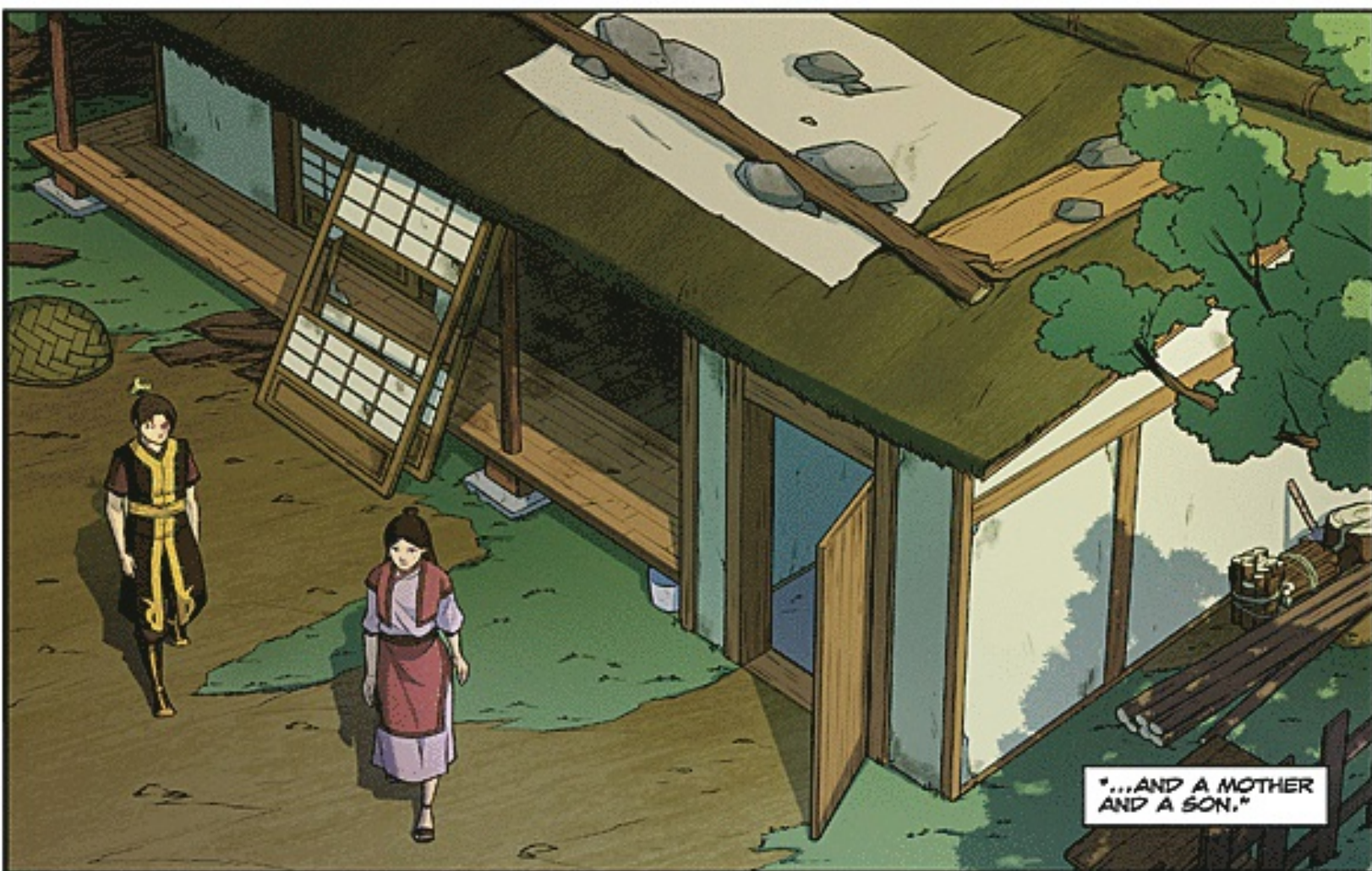


HOLD
STILL.





"WE HELPED BRING
TOGETHER A SISTER
AND A BROTHER..."







I AM A MERCIFUL MAN. I WILL ALLOW THE CHILD TO LIVE, DESPITE THE LOWLINESS OF HIS TRUE HERITAGE. IKEM, HOWEVER --

-- IKEM RICHLY DESERVED HIS PUNISHMENT.

WHAT DID YOU DO?!

I WIPE THAT TREACHEROUS DOG FROM EXISTENCE.

OZAI, HOW COULD YOU --?! YOU KNOW AS WELL AS I THAT ZUKO IS YOUR SON!

OF COURSE HE'S MY SON! I HAD SPIES TRACK YOUR EVERY MOVE FOR MONTHS BEFORE WE WERE MARRIED!

WHY WOULD YOU WRITE SUCH AN OBVIOUS LIE?

MAYBE I WANTED TO SEE IF YOU WERE READING MY PRIVATE LETTERS!

MAYBE I WANTED TO HURT YOU, EVEN FOR A MOMENT!

MAYBE IT WAS JUST MY WISHFUL THINKING.

IS THAT TRULY WHAT YOU WISH, THAT ZUKO WERE NOT MINE?!



YES.



EVERY TIME I SPEAK HARSHLY TO HIM --

-- EVERY TIME I WOUND HIM --

-- EVERY TIME I TREAT ZUKO AS IF HE WERE THE SON OF A TREACHEROUS DOG --

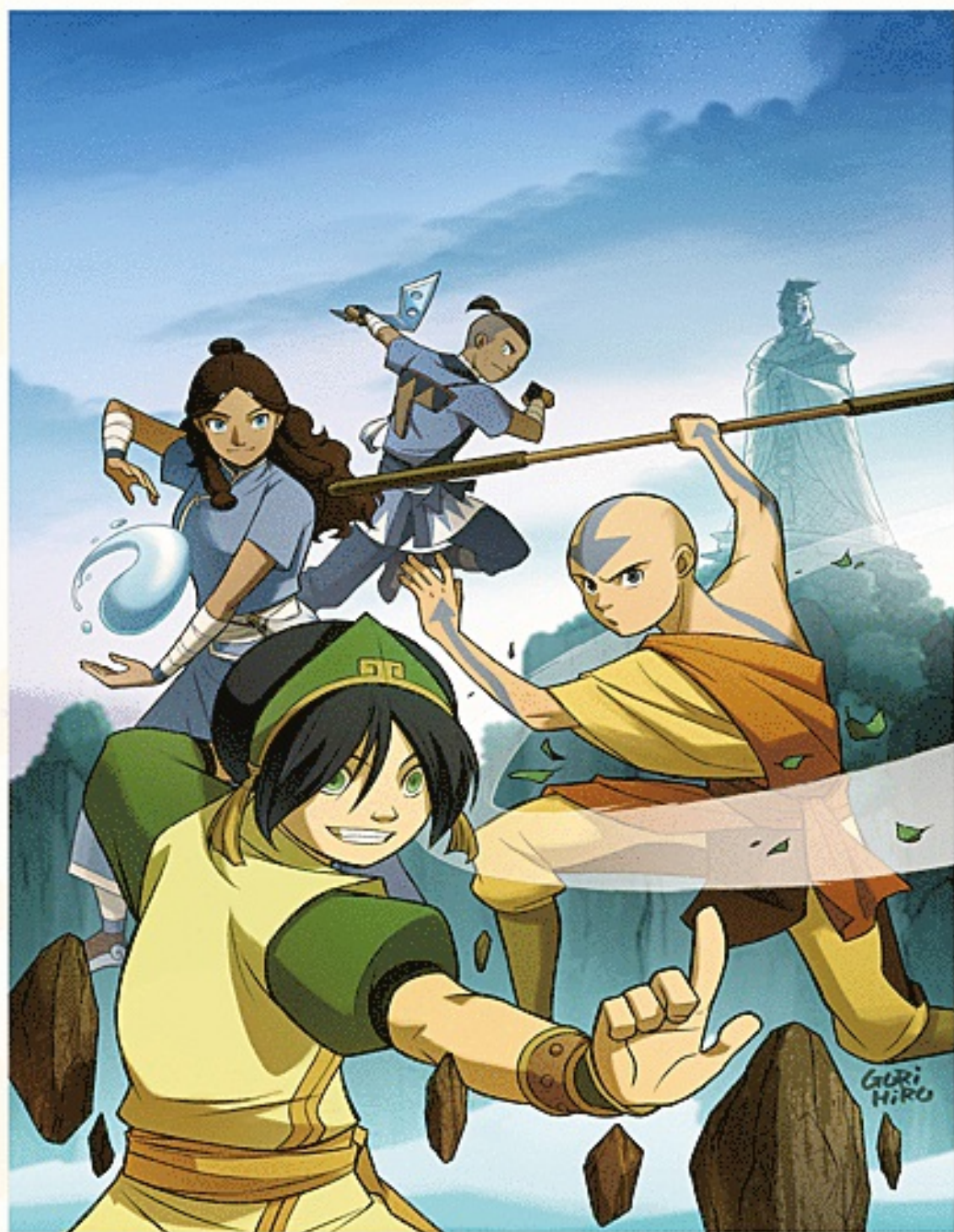


I WILL SIMPLY BE FULFILLING HIS MOTHER'S WISH.









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SON OF



ultron